

4.3 BEN BUCKLER

Ben Buckler Special Character Area is located on the northern headland at Bondi Beach and applies to the area bound by Campbell Parade and the coastline to the west, Bondi Golf Course to the north, and the coastline to the east and south (refer to Figure 3).



Figure 3 Ben Buckler Special Character Area

Existing Character Elements

Ben Buckler exhibits a distinctive palisaded character of parallel streets rising to the outer southern cliff line and lined with Inter War and Mid Century residential flats and housing. Viewed from Bondi Bay, Ben Buckler presents as a dense wall of brick and painted masonry punctuated by glazed openings and a skyline of hipped tile roofs which forms a distinctive and much recognised background to the beach.

Despite the rise of topography to the north and east, streetscapes at Ben Buckler are lined with close set buildings on uniform subdivisions restricting the outlook to glimpses of Bondi Bay, the skyline to the south and the high ground of Bondi Golf course to the north. Only at the extremities of the main streets are vistas of the coastline and beach revealed.

Wide driveways and cross falls to the west, limit the amenity of otherwise wide verges landscaped with turf and sparse coastal tree species. Cranked street alignments to the northern approaches to Campbell Parade, and dense planting within properties to the low side of streets add further to the sense of enclosure.

Within this ground plan the varied styles and forms of construction are unified by orientation of balconies, decks and picture windows southwest over Bondi Bay. The visual complexity of the setting is further emphasized by a distinct separation of public and private space along all streets.

Desired Future Character Objectives

- (a) To maintain the headland character of Ben Buckler through the landscaping of the front gardens and appropriate planting of verges.